

PROJECT SUMMARY/ABSTRACT

[Background paragraph. Describe the condition, population, or scientific problem. Establish prevalence or burden. Identify the data or methodological gap that motivates this project. End with the opportunity (e.g., a data program, technology, or resource) that makes this work feasible now. 2–3 sentences.]

The objective of this *[duration]-[mechanism]* pilot project is to *[create / develop / characterize / validate]* *[brief description of the primary deliverable]*. Our central hypothesis is that *[specific, testable hypothesis]*. To test this hypothesis, we will: (1) *[Aim 1 one-sentence summary]*; (2) *[Aim 2 one-sentence summary]*; and (3) *[Aim 3 one-sentence summary]*.

This project is innovative in *[brief innovation statement — what makes the approach or product novel]*. The expected outcome is *[specific, concrete deliverable or resource]*. By *[mechanism of impact]*, this work will *[broader scientific contribution and significance]*.

PROJECT NARRATIVE

[Sentence 1: What is this project doing? (One plain-language sentence describing the core activity — e.g., "This project will create the first X for Y population.")] *[Sentence 2: What is the expected outcome or deliverable?]*
[Sentence 3 (optional): Why does it matter to public health or biomedical science?]

SPECIFIC AIMS

[Opening paragraph: Establish the problem. Describe the target population or scientific domain, its burden or importance, and the key comorbidity, mechanism, or gap being addressed. Name the most important prior evidence. End with the constraint — what prevents progress now. Cite key literature. 3–4 sentences.]

[Second paragraph: Describe the scientific opportunity. Name the specific resource, technology, or data source that enables this work. Describe the central methodological or conceptual barrier that remains. Frame the gap as solvable. 2–3 sentences.]

The objective of this *[duration]* pilot is to *[create / develop / validate / characterize]* *[brief description of the primary deliverable]*. Our central hypothesis is that *[specific, testable hypothesis in one sentence]*. Our Specific Aims are:

Aim 1: *[Aim 1 title phrase.] [One paragraph describing the aim: what will be done, how it will be done, and what the output will be. Include key methodological choices. 3–4 sentences.]*

Aim 2: *[Aim 2 title phrase.] [One paragraph describing the aim: what will be done, how it will be done, and what the output will be. 3–4 sentences.]*

Aim 3: *[Aim 3 title phrase.] [One paragraph describing the aim: what will be done, how it will be done, and what the output will be. 3–4 sentences.]*

Expected Impact. *[2–3 sentences on broader significance. Connect to the funding priority or NIH strategic goal. Describe what the deliverables enable for the field. State what will be released publicly and under what principles (e.g., FAIR).]*

Multiple PD/PI Leadership Plan

This project will be conducted using a Multiple Principal Investigator (MPI) leadership model to integrate complementary expertise in *[domain 1 — e.g., clinical science]* and *[domain 2 — e.g., computational methodology]*. This structure is essential for achieving the proposed aims, which require both *[what PI 1 uniquely provides]* and *[what PI 2 uniquely provides]*. Leadership is shared between *[PI 1 name]* and *[PI 2 name]*, whose roles are clearly delineated, non-overlapping, and jointly critical to the project's success.

The MPI approach is justified by the scientific scope of the project. *[1–2 sentences explaining why no single investigator could independently provide sufficient depth across the required domains, and how the MPI model ensures balanced leadership and integrated decision-making.]*

[PI 1 Name, credentials] ([role label; e.g., Contact PI, Lead Content Expert]) will *[describe PI 1's primary responsibilities: what they lead, what decisions they own, and what outputs they are accountable for. Include their authority domain. 3–4 sentences.]*

[PI 2 Name, credentials] ([role label; e.g., Lead Methodologist]) will *[describe PI 2's primary responsibilities: what they lead, what decisions they own, and what outputs they are accountable for. Include their authority domain. 3–4 sentences.]*

The two PIs will share responsibility for *[list shared responsibilities: e.g., strategic planning, personnel supervision, joint manuscripts]*. Decisions will be made collaboratively by consensus whenever possible. For domain-specific issues, *[describe the decision-making split by domain]*. If consensus cannot be reached, the Contact PI will make the final determination, with rationale documented.

Communication will be maintained through *[describe meeting cadence: e.g., weekly standing PI meetings and ad hoc meetings during critical phases]*. All project materials will be maintained in shared, version-controlled repositories. In the event of unresolved conflict, *[describe institutional mediation procedure at PI's institution]*.

RESEARCH STRATEGY

A. SIGNIFICANCE

A.1 **[Problem statement subsection title]**

*[Describe the target condition, population, or scientific problem. Establish prevalence/burden with citations. Describe the clinical or scientific importance. Explain what is currently not understood or not possible. 3–5 sentences.]*¹

A.2 **[Knowledge gap subsection title]**

*[Describe the key barrier to progress. This may be a data gap, methodological limitation, or lack of an appropriate tool or resource. Be specific about what is missing and why existing approaches fall short. 3–4 sentences.]*¹

A.3 **[Enabling opportunity subsection title]**

*[Describe the specific resource, technology, or data source that now makes this work possible. Explain why this opportunity is timely. 2–3 sentences.]*¹

A.4 **Significance of the expected contribution**

[State the critical need this project addresses. Describe what the field will be able to do after this project that it cannot do now. Connect to the funding priority or NIH strategic goal. 2–3 sentences.]

B. INNOVATION

This project is innovative along **[N]** distinct dimensions:

B.1 *[Innovation 1 label.]* *[Describe what is new about the approach, resource, or method. Contrast with prior work. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.2 *[Innovation 2 label.]* *[Describe the second innovative dimension. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.3 *[Innovation 3 label.]* *[Describe the third innovative dimension. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.4 *[Innovation 4 label (optional).]* *[Describe reusability, generalizability, or infrastructure innovation. 2–3 sentences.]*

C. APPROACH

C.1 **Research team**

[Describe the team's collective expertise and how it maps to the aims. For MPI submissions, note the Leadership Plan attachment. Name each investigator and their key qualification. Include institutional resources (computing, data governance, IRB) that support feasibility. 2–3 paragraphs.]

C.2 **Preliminary studies**

[Describe prior work by the team that directly supports feasibility. Connect each preliminary finding to a specific aim or methodological choice. If preliminary data are limited (as is common for pilot/R03 applications), describe conceptual or methodological groundwork. 2–3 paragraphs.]

C.3 **Project design and framework**

[Provide a brief overview of the overall study design and conceptual framework. State the number of phases or aims and how they build on each other. Include a figure if it aids comprehension.]

C.4 **Data sources**

[Describe each data source: name, scope, variables of interest, and how CP/cancer (or your target condition) is identified (e.g., ICD codes, registry criteria). State access pathway for any restricted data (dbGaP, DUA, IRB). Note which sources can be accessed immediately vs. at award initiation. Use numbered list or short paragraphs per source.]

C.5 **Data analysis**

C.5.1 Analytic plan for Aim 1. *[Describe the statistical or computational methods for Aim 1. Name specific models, algorithms, or tools. Describe expected inputs and outputs. State evaluation criteria used to select among competing approaches. Use underlined subheadings for major methodological steps if helpful. 3–5 sentences]*

References

[1] Replace with Author. Replace with title, 0000. PLACEHOLDER – replace this entry before submission.